



Portability lives in the artefacts you own

✓ Abstract: thin, firm-owned

where switching is likely and the interface is small

- L5 Memory API**
write · recall · forget by subject · snapshot
- L6 Retrieval interface**
one thin call returning IDs and scores
- L7 Embed and rerank service**
model version on every vector
- L9 Telemetry collector**
firm-owned, open, with redaction
- L9 Evaluation datasets**
datasets and scorers in source control
- C1 Routing contract**
one API contract at the gateway; no provider SDKs
- C3 Privacy API**
detect · transform · re-identify
- C4 Policy as code**
open policy language, with tests
- C5 Configuration fetch**
one call, with a file-based fallback
- C7 Credentials**
workload identity and a vault; no standing secrets

MULTI-VENDOR IS NECESSARY

- two unrelated model vendors
- an open-weight exit route
- two red-team tools, one independent
- two gateway deployments
- two guardrail detectors

✗ Do not over-abstract

wrappers drift behind every upstream release

- L1 Vendor model extras**
only behind an adapter with a feature-free fallback
- L3 Agent frameworks**
no firm-wide wrapper: frameworks on top of frameworks. Keep specification, prompts, tools and evaluations outside, and a rewrite is bounded work
- L3 Single-workflow plug-ins**
one workflow with one model step needs no plug-in architecture
- L6 Plain database access**
no layer between every query and the database
- L6-L7 Store-bundled features**
use only if the model is pinned and raw text is kept outside; never abstract to hide an unpinned model

THE SIGNAL

Framework currency

days behind the pinned framework's latest security fix, held inside the patch window (for example, 30 days)

MULTI-VENDOR ONLY ADDS COMPLEXITY

- two orchestration frameworks
- a second cloud's agent stack
- two vector stores, one corpus
- two observability platforms
- two identity providers for agents